Responsible Administrator: VP Student Affairs
Responsible Office: Dean of Students
Effective Date: 10/31/2017
Approved by: President
Date of Revision: 08/01/2026

Hazing Policy

Policy Statement

In compliance with the federal Stop Campus Hazing Act of 2024; Acts 635, 637, and 640 of the 2018 Regular Session of the Louisiana Legislature; Act 382 of the 2019 Regular Session of the Louisiana Legislature; Act 174 of the 2025 Regular Session of the Louisiana Legislature; Act 309 of the 2026 Regular Session of the Louisiana Legislature; the Louisiana Board of Regents Uniform Policy on Hazing; and the University of Louisiana System Hazing Policy, Southeastern Louisiana University ("the University") reaffirms in this Policy its mandate that any form of hazing is prohibited.

Purpose of Policy

The University does not tolerate hazing, including any form of physical, mental, or psychological abuse of an individual or individuals. The University is committed to fostering an environment of mutual respect, personal dignity, and a healthy organizational and campus culture. All allegations of hazing will be thoroughly investigated by the appropriate authorities. Any organization and/or individuals found responsible for hazing may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and/or including expulsion from the University, and will be referred to law enforcement for possible criminal prosecution in accordance with applicable local, state, and federal laws.

Applicability

This policy applies to all Southeastern Louisiana University students; prospective students; student organizations and potential student organizations; student organization advisors; alumni; volunteers; and faculty and staff associated with student organizations. It also applies to employees of an organization, guests, and third-party affiliates when they are engaged in activities involving or on behalf of student organizations.

Policy Procedure

The University expects all students and members of student organizations to uphold the highest standards of personal and group conduct, both on campus and in any off-campus setting where university-affiliated activities take place. This includes social events, retreats, travel, service activities, and any gathering associated with a student organization.
In addition to following the University's Student Code of Conduct, other University policies, and the policies of their respective organizations, students and members are expected to act as responsible citizens and take action when they witness or become aware of potential hazing behavior. Passive bystander behavior is not consistent with the values of the University. All community members share responsibility for preventing hazing and are encouraged, and in some cases are required by law, to report any suspected hazing activity immediately.

1. **Prevention and Education Programs**

    a. Each new student shall be provided educational information on the dangers of and prohibition on hazing during the new student orientation process, either in person or electronically, in accordance with La. R.S. 17:1801.
    b. If the student receiving this information is a minor, that information shall also be provided to the student's parents or legal guardians.

c. Each student shall annually be provided educational information on the dangers of and prohibition on hazing, either in person or electronically, in accordance with **La. R.S. 17:1801**.
d. The hazing prevention education required in this policy shall include the information about criminal penalties for the crime of criminal hazing. The University shall also provide information to organizations on their obligations under the law, including the duty to investigate and report, and on the possible loss of funding and other penalties applicable to organizations under the hazing laws.
e. In accordance with the Stop Campus Hazing Act, the University shall maintain a centralized web-based platform where students can access hazing prevention education and view disclosures required under federal and state law of hazing incidents.
f. In accordance with the Stop Campus Hazing Act, the University shall provide clear contact information for the individual or office responsible for hazing education, reporting, and enforcement. This information shall be posted online and provided to all students annually.

2. Organization Requirements to Operate at University

Each organization (as defined below in this policy and La. R.S. 17:1801), as a condition of operating at the University, is required to:

a. Adopt the University's Hazing Policy, including its definition of hazing, and incorporate into its governing documents provisions that prohibit hazing as well as outline the possible University sanctions against the organization in the event of a reported or confirmed hazing incident. The organization shall also provide a copy of the University's Hazing Policy, either electronically or in writing, to each member and prospective member prior to initiation, acceptance, or participation in organizational activities.
b. Provide at least two hours annually of hazing prevention education to all members, prospective members, employees, and volunteers of the organization. This training must include instruction on relevant hazing laws and University Policy and may be delivered in person, electronically, or both.
    - If an organization does not provide its own training, its members shall participate in University-delivered hazing prevention education, which may include an online course and participation in designated institutional programs.
c. Submit an annual report to the University listing all individuals of the organization including members, employees, and volunteers, who received such training, supported by attestations confirming their completion.
    - Each recognized student organization must provide an attestation signed by both the organization president and the advisor confirming that all members have satisfied the annual hazing education requirements.
d. The University may require additional participation in specific hazing prevention programming, including scheduled presentations. Organizations may be required to ensure a minimum participation rate in such programs.
e. Each individual designated by the University or a student organization to serve as a student organizational advisor shall annually complete a minimum of one hour of hazing prevention education and training prior to serving as an advisor or in an advisory capacity. The training shall include, at a minimum, an overview of applicable hazing laws and University policies, reporting obligations, and advisor responsibilities related to the prevention of hazing. Advisors shall submit a training completion report to the University evidenced by an attestation of completion.
f. Failure to comply with the hazing prevention education and training requirements of this policy shall result in deactivation of the organization's operations on campus until the organization has satisfied the applicable requirements.

3. Duty to Seek Assistance

a. In accordance with Louisiana R.S. 14:502, any person who is present at the scene of an emergency and knows that another person has suffered serious bodily injury must, if it can be done without danger or peril to self or others, provide reasonable assistance. This includes immediately seeking or reporting the need for medical help from an appropriate authority.
b. This duty also applies to any person whose reckless behavior results in serious bodily injury to another. "Reckless behavior" includes, but is not limited to, excessive alcohol consumption, drug use, drag racing, acts of hazing, or other conduct that a reasonable person should know may result in injury.
c. Reasonable assistance includes immediately contacting an appropriate authority, such as:
    - Any state or local law enforcement agency;
    - A 911 Public Safety Answering Point;
    - Emergency medical personnel.
d. Failure to provide reasonable assistance may result in criminal penalties. A person who fails to act may be fined up to $1,000, imprisoned for up to one year with or without hard labor, or both. If the injured person dies as a result of the incident, the penalty increases to a fine of up to $2,000 and imprisonment for up to five years, with or without hard labor.
e. It is important to note that in accordance with La. **R.S. 14:40.8, consent is not a defense to hazing**. A person's agreement to participate in hazing does not exempt anyone involved from criminal liability or university sanctions..

Louisiana Laws on Hazing

RS 14:40.8 Criminal Hazing

Under Louisiana law, hazing is a criminal offense. R.S. 14:40.8 establishes criminal penalties for individuals who commit hazing and separate reporting obligations and penalties applicable to organizations and education institutions.

Individual Penalties:

- Any person who commits an act of hazing may be fined up to $1,000, imprisoned for up to six months, or both.
- If the hazing results in serious bodily injury, death, or involves forced or coerced alcohol consumption resulting in a blood alcohol concentration of at least 0.30%, the penalties increase to a fine of up to $10,000 and imprisonment for up to five years, with or without hard labor.

Organizational Responsibility:

- If a representative or officer of an organization, including a representative, director, trustee, or officer of a qualifying national or parent organization, knew that one or more members were hazing another person and failed to report the hazing to to law enforcement as soon as practicable under the circumstances, the organization may be subject to:
- A fine of up to $10,000;
- Loss of public funding;
- Suspension of University recognition or rights, for a period not less than four years if the hazing results in serious bodily injury, death, or a blood alcohol level of 0.30% or greater.

RS 17:1801: Hazing Prohibited; Reporting; Documentation; Education; Policies; New Student Orientation; Organizations

Hazing in any form, including any method of initiation into organizations at an education institution supported wholly or in part by public funds, is strictly prohibited when such acts are likely to cause bodily danger or physical punishment to any student or other person attending the institution.

Any person found responsible under this Section shall be expelled, suspended, or dismissed from the University and shall not be permitted to return for at least one semester or comparable academic period.

In addition, individuals may also be subject to prosecution and penalties under R.S. 14:40.8 (Criminal Hazing).

Organizations that discipline a member, representative, or officer for hazing, or have reason to believe that a member has participated in an incident of hazing, must report the incident to law enforcement and the University. If an organization or any of its members, representatives, or officers has been disciplined by a parent organization for hazing, the organization must report the conduct to the University. An organization that fails to make a required report is subject to disciplinary action by the University.

R.S. 17:1801 also establishes requirements for hazing prevention education, victim resources, reporting and documentation, public disclosure of organizational disciplinary findings, online reporting, immunity and amnesty, training, organizational responsibilities, and institutional policies and sanctions. These requirements are incorporated throughout this policy.

Definitions

1. Louisiana law defines **hazing** as any intentional, knowing, or reckless act committed by a person acting alone or with others that is directed against another individual when both of the following apply:

    a. The actor knew or reasonably should have known that the act endangered the physical health or safety of the other individual or caused severe emotional distress.
    b. The act was associated with pledging, initiation into, affiliation with, participation in, holding office in, or maintaining membership in any organization.

    For purposes of this University policy, hazing includes, but is not limited to, any of the following acts associated with pledging, initiation into, affiliation with, participation in, holding office in, or maintaining membership in any organization:

    a. Physical brutality, such as whipping, beating, paddling, striking, branding, electric shocking, placing of a harmful substance on the body, or similar activity.
    b. Physical activity such as sleep deprivation, exposure to the elements, confinement in a small space, or calisthenics, that subjects the other person to an unreasonable risk of harm or that adversely affects the physical health or safety of the individual or causes severe emotional distress.
    c. Activity involving consumption of food, liquid, or any other substance including, but not limited to, an alcoholic beverage or drug, that subjects the individual to an unreasonable risk of harm that adversely affects the physical health or safety of the individual or causes severe emotional distress.
    d. Activity that induces, causes, or requires an individual to perform a duty or task that involves the commission of a crime or an act of hazing.
    e. Activities or events that facilitate rapid drinking, drinking games, intoxication or impairment, and forced consumption of both palatable food and, or any other substance.
    f. Any action taken or situation created that may cause pain, injury, excessive physical stress or fatigue including, but not limited to the following: paddling, slapping, tackling, pushing, and exercise that is not part of a reasonable all-organization athletic event.
    g. Activities that involve the use of rope, string, elastic, or any device or material utilized to restrain or confine an individual.
    h. Activities involving lineups, interrogation, or verbal abuse.

i. Theft or misappropriation of property when used as part of an initiation or group expectation that creates coercive pressure or harm.
j. Transportation against an individual's will such as kidnapping and/or abandonment at distant locations particularly when intended to disorient, endanger, or humiliate.
k. Scavenger hunts or similar activities that require theft, trespass, or other illegal behavior as a condition of participation.
l. Activities or expectations that are so time consuming as to significantly interfere with class work, study time, and sleep.
m. Requirements that financially take advantage of individuals within the group (Requiring an individual to purchase items as punishment).
n. Requiring the use of vulgar or obscene dress, language, or behavior when intended to humiliate, degrade, or cause emotional distress.
o. Sexual degrading activities, including stripping, simulation of sexual acts or sexually explicit cheers, chants, and songs.
p. Conducting any form of personal servitude including, but not limited to driving individuals to class, cleaning another individual's room, serving meals to another individual, washing another individual's car; etc.
q. Activities that cause psychological stress, including any form of deception or manipulation designed to convince a student they will be harmed, removed, or denied membership as part of the activity or process.
r. Requiring individuals to dress in uniforms or costumes in a manner intended to humiliate or degrade (this does not apply to dress attire required for business or ritual meetings).
s. Coercing or requiring individuals to violate University Policy, Federal, State or local law including, but not limited to acts such as theft, trespassing, defacement, animal cruelty, academic dishonesty, or providing false information.

A physical activity that is normal, customary, and necessary for training and participation in an athletic, physical education, military training, or similar program officially sanctioned by the University is not considered hazing for purposes of this policy.

Reporting Hazing Activities and Sanctions

1. **University**

a. When the University receives a report alleging the commission of an act or acts of hazing, the University shall:

i. Report, as soon as practicable under the circumstances and as required by La. **R.S. 14:40.8** and La. **R.S. 17:1801,** the alleged act or acts to the law enforcement agency having jurisdiction in the place where the alleged act or acts of hazing occurred and the University Police Department. The information reported to law enforcement shall include all details received by the University relative to the alleged incident, without any information being redacted, including the name of all individuals alleged to have committed the act or acts of hazing.
ii. Document in writing all actions taken with regard to the report, including but not limited to the date the report was received, reports made to law enforcement as required by R.S. 14:40.8 and R.S. 17:1801, and any information relative to the University's investigation, processing, and resolution of the incident.
iii. In accordance with the Stop Campus Hazing Act of 2024, the University will publish a Hazing Transparency Report that details violations of the University's Hazing Policy and any federal, state, or local laws related to hazing. The report will include a description of each reported incident resulting in a finding of responsibility, the date the conduct occurred, the organization

involved (if applicable), and the outcomes or sanctions imposed.
The Transparency Report will be updated biannually and made available to the public on the University's website. It will include incidents involving student organizations and individuals, whether the hazing occurred on or off campus, and regardless of whether the organization is currently active or has lost recognition. Personally identifiable student information will be redacted in accordance with applicable privacy laws.
This reporting requirement serves to inform the campus community, support hazing prevention efforts, and fulfill the institution's obligations under federal law. Organizations and individuals should be aware that confirmed violations will be reflected in the public report.

iv. In addition to the requirements above, pursuant to Louisiana law, for each organization found responsible for a policy or code violation, the publicly accessible website shall include the name of the organization, each specific policy listed in the Student Code of Conduct that the organization violated, a brief description of the violation presented in a manner that protects individual privacy, the date or academic term in which the violation occurred, the disciplinary sanctions imposed, and the current disciplinary status of the organization. The University shall update this information at least once per academic semester, no later than April 10 and October 10, and additionally as new violations are adjudicated or sanctions are modified or imposed. The University shall establish a minimum period for which disciplinary records and status information remain publicly available, which shall not be shorter than the duration of the sanction and any probationary period. Information published pursuant to this requirement shall exclude the names and personally identifiable information of individual students and comply with applicable state and federal privacy laws.

b. If the University fails to comply with the provisions of the hazing laws it may be subject to the penalties outlined in La. R.S. 14:40.8, including payment of a fine up to ten thousand dollars.

2. Authority of University Police Officers

a. Pursuant to La R.S. 17:1805, university and college police officers are authorized to carry a concealed weapon and to exercise the power of arrest while discharging their duties. This authority specifically extends to alleged acts of hazing committed by members of organizations that are organized and operating at the university or college, regardless of where the alleged act occurs.
b. Any person arrested by a university or college police officer in connection with such conduct shall be immediately transferred to the custody of the sheriff or city police within whose jurisdiction the arrest occurred.

3. Organizations and Affiliates

a. If an organization takes disciplinary action against one of its members for hazing or has reason to believe that any member of the organization has participated in an incident of hazing, the organization shall report the incident as soon as practicable to law enforcement and to the Dean of Students without any information being redacted, including the name of all individuals alleged to have committed the act or acts of hazing.
b. If an organization or any of its members has been disciplined by a parent organization for hazing, the organization shall report the hazing for which the organization was disciplined as soon as practicable to law enforcement and the Dean of Students without any information being redacted, including the name of all individuals alleged to have committed the act or acts of hazing
c. If any person serving as a representative or officer of an organization (including but not limited to, any representative, director, trustee, or officer of any national or parent organization) knew and failed to report, as soon as practicable under the circumstances, to law enforcement that one of the

organizations members were hazing another person, the organization may be subject to penalties under R.S. 14:40.8.

d. If an organization fails to report an incident of hazing as required by this policy and applicable law, the University shall impose disciplinary action against the organization in accordance with University policy.

4. Students

a. Any student who violates the provisions of the hazing laws and/or this policy shall be suspended, expelled, or dismissed from the University; will not be permitted to return for at least one semester, and may be subject to criminal charges.
b. Any student who fails to seek assistance as defined by the hazing laws and this policy shall be subject to the penalties outlined in La. RS. 14:40.8.

5. Mandated Reporting Requirements

a. All faculty and staff who become aware of a potential hazing incident must report it both internally and to the appropriate external authorities per federal guidelines.
b. A failure to report could result in University-imposed sanctions and/or professional disciplinary action as outlined under institutional policies.
c. Any faculty or staff who fails to seek assistance as defined by the hazing laws and this policy shall be subject to the penalties outlined in La. RS. 14:40.8

6. How a student or employee should report

The University is committed to the safety and well-being of all students. If you are being hazed, or if you know someone in your organization or student group who is hazing or being hazed, we want you to be aware of your options in seeking assistance and reporting to the following designees:

1. University Police Department:
    - 985-549-2222
    - police@southeastern.edu
    - Anonymous Reporting Form
2. Office of Student Advocacy and Accountability
    - 985-549-2213
    - Incident Reporting Form
3. Office for Student Engagement
    - 985-549-2120
    - student.engagement@southeastern.edu
4. Dean of Students
    - 985-549-3792
    - deanofstudents@southeastern.edu
5. University Housing
    - 985-549-2118
    - universityhousing@southeastern.edu
6. Athletic Department
    - 985-549-2395
    - lionscompliance@southeastern.edu
7. University Health Center
    - 985-549-2242
    - health@southeastern.edu

8. University of Louisiana System
    - Louisiana System Anonymous Reporting Form
9. Human Resources
    - 985-549-2001
    - HR@southeastern.edu

Many organizations and groups also have internal procedures for reporting hazing. Please see your advisors and/or coaches for information specific to your organization or group.

Additionally, any faculty member or staff member that becomes aware of possible hazing of Southeastern Louisiana University students must immediately report the matter to one of the offices listed above.

The University and student organizations shall make available and provide information about resources to any student who is an alleged victim of hazing, including information on how to access medical and reporting resources and counseling offered by the University or community.

Enforcement of Hazing Policy

Any violation of the Hazing Policy shall be deemed a violation of the University's Student Code of Conduct and applicable laws. Thus, all allegations of hazing will be investigated by local law enforcement, the University Police Department, and the Office of Student Advocacy and Accountability. In accordance with University policy and state law, individual students or groups found responsible for hazing shall be suspended, expelled, or dismissed from the University and will not be permitted to return for at least one semester. If a hazing violation by an organization results in the death of a person, the University shall banish the organization and prohibit its re-chartering, re-establishment, or operation under any name, alias, or affiliated organization. The Office of Student Advocacy and Accountability may impose interim sanctions immediately upon notice of charge of violation of the Hazing Policy.

Each individual serving on a University hearing panel or disciplinary body responsible for adjudicating alleged hazing violations shall annually complete a minimum of one hour of hazing prevention education and training prior to serving. The training shall include hazing definitions and indicators, applicable laws and University policies, trauma-informed practices, due process considerations, and sanctioning standards for hazing violations. Hearing panelists shall submit a training completion report to the University evidenced by an attestation of completion.

The University strictly prohibits retaliation by any individual or group, regardless of whether the person was directly involved in the original incident, against any student, faculty, or staff member who reports hazing, participates in an investigation, or serves as a complainant or witness in a disciplinary proceeding involving a hazing allegation. Allegations of retaliation will be investigated as a violation of this policy and may result in disciplinary action, including suspension or expulsion.

The University maintains an online reporting system that permits third-party reporting and allows individuals to submit confidential or anonymous reports of hazing. While anonymous reports can assist in identifying potential concerns, formal disciplinary action cannot be based solely on an anonymous report without additional supporting information. The University will take reasonable steps to review and respond to anonymous reports to the extent possible.

Knowingly submitting a false report of hazing is strictly prohibited and constitutes a violation of University policy. Individuals found to have made intentionally false allegations may be subject to disciplinary action under the University's Student Code of Conduct. This provision is not intended to discourage good-faith reports, even if the facts cannot ultimately be substantiated.

A person acting in good faith who reports or assists in the investigation of a report of an incident of hazing, or who testifies or otherwise participates in a disciplinary process or judicial proceeding arising from such a report, shall not be subjected to disciplinary action by the University for a violation of the University's Student Code of Conduct that is

reasonably related to the reported incident, provided that suspension or expulsion is not a possible sanction for the violation. This protection shall not apply to a person who perpetrates or assists in the perpetration of the reported hazing incident.

The University shall provide amnesty to any student who reports hazing to the University in good faith. Such student shall not be sanctioned by the University for a nonviolent student conduct violation, such as underage drinking, that is revealed in the course of making the report.

These protections do not shield an individual from criminal or civil liability under state or federal law.

[End of Policy]